Ford Motor Company

October 2000

TO: All Ford and Lincoln Mercury Dealers

SUBJECT: **Safety Recall 00S33**: All 1999 and Certain 2000 Model Year Mercury Villager Vehicles – Steering Gear Retaining Bolt Inspection

AFFECTED VEHICLES

All 1999 and 2000 model year Mercury Villager vehicles built at the Ohio Assembly Plant through March 6, 2000.

SAFETY CONCERN

In some of the affected vehicles the steering gear retaining bolts may not be tightened to specification. This may result in wander, a vague on-center feel or a clear vision concern caused by movement of the steering gear. If these symptoms are ignored vehicle handling could eventually be adversely affected.

SERVICE ACTION

Before demonstrating or delivering any of the vehicles involved in this recall, the dealers are to inspect, and if necessary tighten the five (5) steering gear retaining bolts to specification. In some extremely rare cases, it may be necessary to install missing bolts, or replace worn steering gear retaining brackets. This must be done on all of the affected vehicles.

PLEASE NOTE

Correct all vehicles in stock before delivery. Federal law requires dealers to complete any outstanding safety recall service before a new vehicle is delivered to the buyer or lessee. Violation of this requirement by a dealer could result in a civil penalty of up to $1,100 per vehicle.

ATTACHMENTS

Attachment I: Administrative Information
Attachment II: Labor Allowances and Parts Ordering Information
Attachment III: Technical Information
Customer Notification Letter

QUESTIONS?

Claims Information:……..……....1-800-423-8851

Other (Dealer Only) Recall Questions:……..……...1-800-325-5621

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

Safety Recall 00S33
Certain 1999 and 2000 Model Year Mercury Villager vehicles – Steering Gear Retaining Bolt Torque

OASIS

You must use OASIS to determine if a vehicle is eligible for this recall.

PROMPTLY CORRECT

Promptly correct all affected vehicles on your dealer VIN list which you will receive in the Ford Dealer Consolidated Communicator (FDCC). Also, correct other eligible vehicles that are brought to your dealership.

DEALER-OWNER CONTACT

Immediately contact any affected owner whose name is not on the list. Give the owner a copy of the Owner Letter and schedule a service date.

REGIONAL CONTACT

Advise regional office if an owner:

- cannot be contacted.
- does not make a service date.

CLAIMS PREPARATION AND SUBMISSION

- Enter claims using DWE.
- Refer to ACESII manual for claims preparation and submission information.

OWNER REFUNDS

Ford Motor Company will only refund owner-paid repairs made before the date of the Owner Letter (or after the date of the Owner Letter if an emergency repair was made away from the servicing dealer). Refer to ACESII manual for refund information.

RENTAL CARS

If inspection reveals that a bolt is missing, or a retaining bracket is damaged, parts will have to be ordered. In this event Ford Motor Company will pay for a rental vehicle, except for fuel, which will be at owner's expense. Enter the word "RENTAL" plus the number of days the vehicle was used in the Miscellaneous Expense area.

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LABOR ALLOWANCES

Description	Labor Time	Labor Operation
Verify Bolt Torque five (5) bolts	0.2 Hrs.	00S33A
Inspect one (1) bracket for wear, and if necessary replace damaged bracket, or replace missing bolts on one side, and retorque to specifications	0.4 Hrs.	00S33B
Inspect two (2) brackets for wear, and if necessary replace damaged bracket (s), or replace missing bolts on both sides and retorque to specifications	0.5 Hrs.	00S33C
Administrative Allowance	0.1 Hrs.	Misc. Expense Code "ADMIN

PARTS REQUIREMENTS

Parts Ordering Information

Very few, if any vehicles will require parts. If parts are required please contact the Recall Hotline at 1-800-248-0186. The necessary parts will be shipped directly to your dealership Priority Next Day Air.

Order Information DOR/COR number 50189 identifies parts ordered for this campaign through the Recall Hotline 1-800–248-0186.

Stock Orders	First 30 days after launch	Call 1-800-248-0186
Interim	First 30 days after launch	Call 1-800-248-0186
Emergency	First 30 days after launch	Call 1-800-248-0186
All Orders	31 days after launch	Normal Order Process

DEALER PRICE

For latest prices, refer to:

- DOES II
- Updated Price Book

Ford Motor Company

Ford Motor Company
P. O. Box 1904
Dearborn, Michigan 48121
1-800-392-3673

October 2000

00S33

Mr. John Sample
123 Main Street
Anywhere, USA 12345

Your Vehicle Identification Number: 12345678901234567

This notice is sent to you in accordance with the requirements of the National Traffic and Motor Vehicle Safety Act.

Ford Motor Company has decided that a defect which relates to motor vehicle safety exists in certain 1999 and 2000 Mercury Villager vehicles built through March 6, 2000.

We apologize for this situation and want to assure you that, with your assistance, we will correct this condition. Our commitment, together with Ford and Lincoln Mercury dealers, is to provide you with the highest level of service and support possible.

What the safety issue is …	In some of the affected vehicles, the steering gear retaining bolts may not have been tightened to specification. This condition could cause a wander, a vague feel in the steering, or a steering wheel misalignment. If not corrected, vehicle handling could ultimately be affected.
What Ford Motor Company and your dealer will do ...	Ford Motor Company will repair your vehicle free of charge (parts and labor). Owners who are affected by this recall are requested to return their vehicle to their dealer for inspection. If necessary, the steering gear retaining bolts will be tightened to specification.
How long will it take?	The time needed for this repair is less than one-half day. However, due to service scheduling issues, your dealer may need your vehicle for a longer period of time.

What we are asking you to do …

Call your dealer without delay. Ask for a service date for Safety Recall 00S33.

If inspection reveals that a part must be ordered, your dealer is authorized to provide you with a rental vehicle at no charge (except for fuel) until the parts arrive. Parts would be expected to arrive within a week after ordering.

When you bring your vehicle in, show the dealer this letter. If you misplace this letter, your dealer will still do the work, free of charge.

If you've already paid for this service …

If you paid to have this service done before the date of this letter, Ford is offering a full refund. For the refund, please give your paid original receipt to your dealer. To avoid delays, do not send receipts to Ford Motor Company.

If you've changed address or sold the vehicle …

Please fill out the enclosed prepaid postcard and mail it to us if you have changed address or sold the vehicle.

If you have concerns …

If you have trouble getting your vehicle repaired promptly and without charge, please contact your dealership's Service Manager. If you still need assistance, please contact the Ford Motor Company Customer Relationship Center and one of our representatives will be happy to assist you:

CALL: (800) 392-3673
(800) 232-5952 (TDD for the Hearing Impaired)

Office Hours: (Eastern Standard Time)

Monday-Friday: 8am - 11pm
Saturday: 9am - 6pm

or you may contact us through the Internet at:
www.ownerconnection.com
Our current response time to Internet inquiries is three business days.

You also may send a complaint to the Administrator, National Highway Traffic Safety Administration, 400 Seventh Street, S. W., Washington, D. C. 20590 or call the toll free Auto Safety Hotline 1-800-424-9393 (Washington, D. C. area residents may call 1-202-366-0123).

Quality Care service is there for you all year round.

QualityCare™ at your service

Quality Care is the commitment of Ford Motor Company and its dealerships to provide you with a superior service and ownership experience. While we regret the inconvenience caused by this program, we stand committed with our dealers to assist you with all of your automotive service needs. With our nationwide dealer network, we're here to ensure you receive Quality Care service so that your vehicle maintains peak performance throughout your ownership experience.

We pride ourselves on becoming the world's leading consumer company for automotive products and services. Thank you for your attention to this important matter.

Sincerely,



Ann O'Neill
Director
Vehicle Service and Programs

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Ford Customer Service Division